



I took this picture of my daughter, Savannah, and Linda one sunny morning in Boston. I remember looking through the viewfinder and thinking about how much my life was about to change and what new responsibilities were to come. Planning on having a family? You need to think through the financial implications in tandem with the emotional ones.

But that's not the whole story. Many women today have successful, lucrative careers. A recent Pew report found that four in 10 households with children have a woman as the primary breadwinner, and sometimes she is the *sole* breadwinner. Fifty years ago, that statistic was one in 10. Single mothers account for many of those households today, but in over five million cases, the couple is married; the wife simply makes more than her husband.

I point this out for a reason: so that you don't get stymied by conventional expectations. Whoever can make money and wants to work should do it! At the beginning of your marriage, you're in the maximum debt—you may both be paying off your student loans, and now you have a mortgage *and* a baby. You want to make your 90-Day Number as high as you can possibly get it. If you decide to have kids, take a cold hard look at the numbers. Who has the higher earning potential? That's who goes to work. The other one works to